

tmux

The Terminal Multiplexer Cheatsheet

One terminal. Many sessions. Zero stress.

A friendly, visual reference for the keys, panes, and patterns you'll use every day.

```
~ tmux: dev

$ tmux new -s dev # start a session
$ vim app.py
└─ press Ctrl-b % ───────── split vertical
└─ press Ctrl-b " ───────── split horizontal
└─ press Ctrl-b d ───────── detach (your work keeps running)

$ tmux attach -t dev # come back any time, anywhere
[detached] reattaching session 'dev'...
```

0:vim* 1:server 2:logs "dev" 14:32 25-Apr-26

60+

SHORTCUTS

4

PAGES

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PRODUCTIVITY



PRINT & PIN IT



THE MAGIC KEY

Every shortcut starts with the prefix

ctrl + b

► How tmux is organized

tmux server



session



window



pane

*one machine**like a workspace**like a tab**like a split*

S Sessions

New session	<code>tmux new -s name</code>
List sessions	<code>tmux ls</code>
Attach session	<code>tmux a -t name</code>
Kill session	<code>tmux kill-session -t name</code>
Detach (keep running)	<code>prefix d</code>
Switch session	<code>prefix s</code>
Rename session	<code>prefix \$</code>

W Windows (Tabs)

New window	<code>prefix c</code>
Next window	<code>prefix n</code>
Previous window	<code>prefix p</code>
Last window	<code>prefix l</code>
Jump to window N	<code>prefix 0-9</code>
Find window by name	<code>prefix f</code>
Rename window	<code>prefix ,</code>
Close window	<code>prefix &</code>

★ **Pro tip:** Detached sessions stay alive in the background. Close your terminal, log out, even SSH back in tomorrow — your work is right where you left it. That's the tmux superpower.

P Splitting & Closing

Split vertically (left right)	prefix	%
Split horizontally (top bottom)	prefix	"
Close current pane	prefix	x
Toggle pane zoom (full screen)	prefix	z
Break pane into new window	prefix	!
Convert window into pane	prefix	:join-pane

→ Navigation

Move to pane (arrow)	prefix	↑ ↓ ← →
Cycle through panes	prefix	o
Show pane numbers	prefix	q
Jump to pane N	prefix	q then N
Swap with previous pane	prefix	{
Swap with next pane	prefix	}

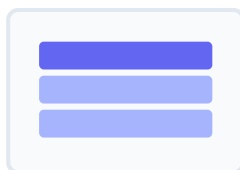
↔ Resize Panes

Resize left (5 cells)	prefix	Ctrl-←
Resize right (5 cells)	prefix	Ctrl-→
Resize up (5 cells)	prefix	Ctrl-↑
Resize down (5 cells)	prefix	Ctrl-↓
Custom resize	prefix	:resize-pane -D 10

↻ Layouts

Cycle preset layouts	prefix	Space
Even horizontal	prefix	Alt-1
Even vertical	prefix	Alt-2
Main horizontal	prefix	Alt-3
Main vertical	prefix	Alt-4
Tiled	prefix	Alt-5

Visual Layout Guide



Even Horizontal
Alt-1



Even Vertical
Alt-2



Main Horizontal
Alt-3



Main Vertical
Alt-4



Tiled
Alt-5



Copy Mode (Scroll & Yank)

Enter copy mode	prefix <code>[</code>
Exit copy mode	<code>q</code>
Move (vi keys)	<code>h j k l</code>
Page up / down	<code>Ctrl-u</code> / <code>Ctrl-d</code>
Search forward	<code>/</code>
Search backward	<code>?</code>
Begin selection	<code>Space</code>
Copy selection	<code>Enter</code>
Paste buffer	prefix <code>]</code>
List paste buffers	prefix <code>=</code>



Misc & Help

Show help (all keys)	prefix <code>?</code>
Command prompt	prefix <code>:</code>
Reload config	prefix <code>:source ~/.tmux.conf</code>
Clock mode (yes really)	prefix <code>t</code>
Refresh client	prefix <code>r</code>
Toggle synchronized panes	prefix <code>:setw sync on</code>
Mouse mode on / off	prefix <code>:set mouse on</code>
Kill server (everything)	<code>tmux kill-server</code>

Shell command	What it does
<code>tmux</code>	Start a new unnamed session
<code>tmux new -s work</code>	Start a session called <i>work</i>
<code>tmux ls</code>	List active sessions
<code>tmux a</code>	Attach to the most recent session
<code>tmux a -t work</code>	Attach to a specific session
<code>tmux new -As work</code>	Attach if it exists, create if not (very handy)
<code>tmux kill-session -t work</code>	Kill a session by name
<code>tmux rename-session -t old new</code>	Rename a session

★ **Workflow tip:** Use `tmux new -As project` in a `cd ~/code/project && tmux new -As project` alias. One command to either resume your work or start fresh — your fingers will thank you.

Drop these lines into `~/.tmux.conf`, then reload with `prefix :source ~/.tmux.conf`. A great config is the difference between using tmux and *loving* tmux.

```
# — Saner prefix: Ctrl-a is easier than Ctrl-b ————— unbind C-b set-option -g
prefix C-a bind-key C-a send-prefix # — Splits that remember the current path
————— bind | split-window -h -c "#{pane_current_path}" bind - split-window -v
-c "#{pane_current_path}" # — vim-style pane navigation —————
bind h select-pane -L bind j select-pane -D bind k select-pane -U bind l select-pane -R
# — Mouse on, 1-indexed windows, big history ————— set -g mouse on set -g base-
index 1 setw -g pane-base-index 1 set -g history-limit 50000 # — Quick-reload key
————— bind r source-file ~/.tmux.conf \; display "🔄
reloaded"
```



The Top 10 Keys to Memorize First

d

detach

c

new window

%

split |

"

split —

z

zoom pane

[

copy mode

x

kill pane

,

rename win

s

switch sess

?

help!

★ **The 80/20 of tmux:** Master the prefix, plus d, c, %, ", and z. That's ~80% of daily tmux. Everything else is icing.